यस्य जगति स्पन्दति चेतनामूर्तिः
सा देवतानां विभुरुच्यते स्पन्दः।
तं ज्ञात्वा स्पन्दितुमनाहविद्यमानः
ब्रह्मात्मभावं प्रविलाप्य सर्वदा॥

In Trika Shaivism, the individual soul, known as anu, is regarded as a microcosmic reflection of the divine consciousness. Each individual is believed to possess the innate potential to realise their true nature as divine beings. However, this realisation is often obstructed by the limitations of the ego, ignorance, and attachment to worldly experiences. The path of Trika Shaivism involves the systematic unravelling of these limitations and the awakening of the dormant divine consciousness within.

Trika Shaivism offers a comprehensive framework for spiritual practice and self-realisation. It encompasses various methods, including mantra recitation, meditation, breath control, ritual worship, and contemplative inquiry. These practices are designed to purify the mind, cultivate heightened awareness, and ultimately lead to the direct experience of the divine. One of the distinguishing features of Trika Shaivism is its emphasis on the direct transmission of spiritual knowledge from teacher to student, or more broadly, experiential accessibility to insights into the nature of reality. This lineage-based transmission, known as *śaktipāt*, involves the transfer of spiritual energy and awakening through the grace of an enlightened master. *Guru-shishya parampara* (the tradition of passing spiritual knowledge from guru to disciple) is considered vital in Trika Shaivism, as the guidance and blessings of a realised teacher are seen as essential for the spiritual aspirant’s progress.

In Kashmir Shaivism, the descent of divine grace, or śaktipāt, is categorised into different levels as shown below:

1. **Tīvra-tīvra-śaktipāt:** This highest level results in immediate liberation and oneness with Shiva.
2. **Tīvra-madhya-śaktipāt:** This level leads to self-realised enlightenment without the need for a guru.